

INDIVIDUAL ASSIGNMENT-1

Annual Report Analysis

Submitted by
MD SHOWRAV ZAMAN
Student ID: 1000055235

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1. City Bank PLC

City Bank's annual report is written as an integrated report (financial + governance + sustainability). The report explains that in 2024 the banking sector had stress, and stronger banks got more deposit confidence. City Bank highlights that its deposits grew strongly and loans also increased, which shows business growth. They also emphasize risk management, especially controlling NPL—and keeping strong provisioning. Another point is that City Bank is trying to grow digitally (banking apps and digital services) and also maintain efficiency. For dividends, the report mentions 12.5% cash dividend + 12.5% stock dividend (subject to approval). The report also mentions that the major risks for banks are credit risk, regulatory changes, and macro instability, so they are focusing more on strong borrowers and also keeping good liquidity.

Key performance highlights (financial)

- **Deposits:** BDT 514,204 mn (reported as 31% YoY growth)
- **Loans & advances:** BDT 444,978 mn (reported 12.3% YoY growth)
- **Net profit:** BDT 10,851 mn (major YoY improvement)
- **Operating profit:** BDT 23,053 mn, EPS: BDT 8.06, Gross NPL: 3.7%, Provision coverage: 106.8%

Takeaways

Business & Market

- Benefited from deposit growth because customers prefer stronger banks in crisis.
- Maintained a low NPL ratio compared to sector situation.

Strategy & Operations

- Focus on strong corporate borrowers and controlled lending.
- Digital banking and efficiency are major priorities.

Shareholder Return

- Dividend has both cash and stock which is common for banks.

Risks & Outlook

- Credit risk and macro pressure are the biggest issues.
- Strong provisioning coverage is a safety buffer.

2. Grameenphone Ltd.

Grameenphone is one of the biggest telecom companies in Bangladesh and the report shows how they are trying to move from only telecom services to more “digital” services (telco-tech). In 2024 they had 84.3 million subscribers and 48 million internet users, so their scale is still a strong advantage. They focused a lot on improving the network and customer experience, and they also pushed more users to use digital channels like MyGP. At the same time, the company mentioned that the year was challenging because of inflation, currency pressure, and political issues (including internet blackouts), which affected the business environment. For shareholders, Grameenphone continued a strong dividend policy: they recommended BDT 17/share final cash dividend and said total dividend for 2024 was BDT 33/share including interim. The report also shows that regulatory/legal issues are an important risk area for them, and in the future they want to keep investing in the network, control costs, and grow more digital services.

Key performance highlights (financial + operating)

- **Revenue:** BDT 158,447,003 (000) in 2024 (slight decline vs 2023).
- **Profit after tax:** BDT 36,308,727 (000); EPS: 26.89.
- Management notes the second half faced political unrest and internet blackouts, plus macro pressure; operating profit declined but NPAT grew 9.8% to BDT 36.3b.
- Network expansion included deployment investments (capex shown) and continued spectrum deployments to improve experience.

Takeaways

Business & Market

- Market leader with very large subscriber base, so scale is a big strength.
- Data/internet usage is the main growth area.

Strategy & Operations

- Big focus on network investment and modernization.
- Digital platforms like MyGP are important for customer engagement.

Risks & Outlook

- Regulatory and legal issues can impact earnings.
- Political disruption and blackouts can affect usage and revenue.

3. British American Tobacco Bangladesh (BATB)

BAT Bangladesh's report highlights that they are one of the biggest corporate taxpayers in Bangladesh and they contributed a very large amount to government revenue. They explain that 2024 was not easy because of inflation and higher costs but they managed expenses and continued profitability. The report also talks a lot about sustainability and governance and they show it as a part of their value creation model. For shareholders, BATB recommended BDT 15/share final cash dividend (150%). Most of their business risks are related to taxes, regulation and illicit trade, because these directly affect cigarette market demand and pricing. Their outlook is focused on stable growth and managing policy impacts while protecting the business.

Key performance highlights (financial)

Key reported figures for 2024 include:

- **Net turnover:** BDT 9,945 crore
- **Profit before tax:** BDT 3,381 crore
- **Profit after tax:** BDT 1,751 crore
- **EPS:** BDT 32.42
- **Contribution to national exchequer:** BDT 34,173 crore

Takeaways

Business & Market

- Very strong market position and major contributor to national revenue.
- Business is highly dependent on government policy and taxes.

Strategy & Operations

- Focus on cost control and efficiency under inflation pressure.
- Sustainability and governance reporting is a big part of the report.

Shareholder Return

- Regular dividend payout, strong for shareholders.

Risks & Outlook

- Tax/regulation changes and illicit trade are the biggest risks.
- Consumer affordability pressure can affect volume.

4. LafargeHolcim Bangladesh PLC

LafargeHolcim Bangladesh operates in cement and related building materials and they also highlight aggregates and Geocycle (waste co-processing) as future focus areas. The report says 2024 was difficult because the cement sector is impacted by currency devaluation, dollar shortage, and energy costs. Since many raw materials are import dependent, FX and logistics costs are big challenges. Still, the company shows that it managed performance through efficiency and sustainability initiatives like alternative fuel usage (their TSR is 10.5%). Regarding shareholder return, they had 19% interim cash dividend and recommended 0% final dividend, but total recommended dividend is shown as 38% cash (BDT 3.80/share) for 2024. The key risks remain energy costs, FX volatility, and construction demand changes, and outlook depends a lot on infrastructure activity and stable macro environment.

Key performance highlights (financial + operating)

- **Net sales / revenue:** BDT 27,543 million
- **Profit for the year (PAT):** BDT 3,819 million
- **EPS:** Tk. 3.29
- Report notes challenges: currency devaluation, inflation, high raw material/energy costs; also highlights a Thermal Substitution Rate (TSR) of 10.5% and energy efficiency improvements.

Takeaways

Business & Market

- Cement demand depends on construction/infrastructure sector.
- High dependency on imported inputs makes FX risk important.

Strategy & Operations

- Efficiency initiatives and alternative fuel use reduce cost and emissions.
- Aggregates and Geocycle give extra business opportunities.

Shareholder Return

- Dividend policy is communicated through interim + total dividend approach.

Risks & Outlook

- Energy, FX and demand slowdown are the main risks.
- Future performance depends on cost control and demand recovery.

5. Beximco Pharmaceuticals Ltd.

Beximco Pharma is one of the leading pharma companies in Bangladesh and the report focuses on export expansion, product pipeline, and compliance quality. They have a large product portfolio and also operate through subsidiaries like Nuvista and Synovia. In 2023–24 they launched many new products locally (Beximco, Nuvista, Synovia all contributed), and they also emphasize international market approvals and registrations, including regulated markets like the USA and Australia. The report highlights awards/recognitions which support their branding and credibility. For dividend, the board recommended 40% cash dividend (Tk. 4/share). The major risks discussed are FX risk (because of import dependency and foreign currency transactions), regulatory compliance, and financial risks (interest rate, liquidity, etc.). Outlook-wise, they aim to keep growing exports, increase approvals, and maintain strong quality and compliance standards.

Key performance highlights (financial + operating)

Consolidated 2023–24 highlights:

- **Net revenue:** BDT 44,391.6m
- **Profit after tax:** BDT 5,866.8m
- **EPS:** BDT 13.07
- **NAV per share:** BDT 107.48

Operating expansion:

- New products launched in Bangladesh: Beximco 30, Nuvista 20, Synovia 11 (domestic launches during the year).
- Global footprint: presence in 60+ countries (export destinations shown).

Takeaways

Business & Market

- Strong domestic base and growing export footprint.
- Competitive advantage comes from compliance and approvals in regulated markets.

Strategy & Operations

- Many new product launches show strong pipeline activity.
- International approvals support long-term export growth.

Shareholder Return

- Cash dividend recommendation shows focus on shareholder payout.

Risks & Outlook

- FX volatility and import dependence can pressure costs and margins.
- Regulatory and compliance requirements remain critical for global expansion.

Dimension	Grameenphone	City Bank	BAT Bangladesh	LafargeHolcim Bangladesh	Beximco Pharma
Industry	Telecom	Banking	FMCG (Tobacco)	Cement / Building Materials	Pharmaceuticals
Revenue Scale	Highest	Large	Highest	Medium–Large	Large
Profitability	Very High	Moderate–High	High	Moderate	Moderate
Growth Driver	Data + Digital ecosystem (MyGP), network investment	Deposit growth + loans expansion + digital banking	Pricing/mix + volume management + distribution strength	Infrastructure demand + efficiency + new building solutions	Export expansion + product portfolio + regulated market focus
Primary Risk	Regulation + spectrum/telco policy	NPL/credit risk + macro volatility	Regulation + tax structure + illicit trade	Energy costs + demand slowdown	FX + high debt/finance cost + regulatory compliance

Table: Comparison table

Appendix.

1. The City Bank PLC — Annual Report 2024

Web page: [Annual Report 2024](#)

2. Grameenphone Ltd. — Annual Report 2024

Web page: [Annual Report 2024 | Grameenphone](#)

Direct PDF:

<https://cdn01da.grameenphone.com/sites/default/files/2025-04/GP%20Annual%20Report%202024.pdf>

3. LafargeHolcim Bangladesh PLC — Annual Report 2024

Direct PDF:

<https://www.lafargeholcim.com.bd/sites/bangladesh/files/docs/lhb-annual-report-2024.pdf>

4. Beximco Pharmaceuticals Ltd. — Annual Report 2023–24

Direct PDF: <https://beximco-pharma.com/investor/annual-report-2023-24.pdf>

5. British American Tobacco Bangladesh (BAT Bangladesh) — Investors & Financial Statements

Web page: [British American Tobacco Bangladesh - Financial Statements](#)